

With the arrival of trains, which had to run according to timetables, people began to live their lives by the clock.



Iron foundry

Abraham Darby replaced charcoal (made from wood) with coke (made from coal) for making a new kind of tough iron.



Ironbridge

Made of metal

In 1779, Abraham Darby III built the first iron bridge across the river Severn. The place is now called Ironbridge. The Eiffel Tower was built in Paris in 1889 and is more than 980 feet (300 meters) high.



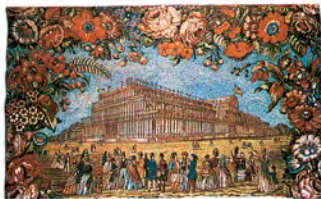
Eiffel Tower



The invention of electroplating made it possible to coat iron objects with silver. They looked like solid silver but were far cheaper to make.

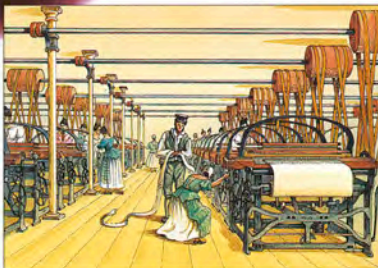
Vast numbers of machine-made cups and plates were turned out for everyday use.

The invention of artificial dyes in the 1850s meant that cloth did not fade when it was washed.



The Great Exhibition

In 1851, the Great Exhibition was opened in London, inside a huge glass building called the Crystal Palace. The Exhibition displayed all the latest industrial developments.



Factory life

The first factories were built to contain the heavy machinery needed to produce cotton cloth. Whole families—even young children—kept the machines going night and day.

